

Petition 1 — Enhancement of Agricultural Electricity Connection to 5 HP for Deep Borewells in the Chittur Rain-Shadow Belt

To: Shri Sunny Joseph Hon'ble Minister for Electricity, Government of Kerala Thiruvananthapuram

Copy to: 1. Shri T. Siddique, Hon'ble Minister for Agriculture 2. Shri Mons Joseph, Hon'ble Minister for Water Resources (Irrigation & Ground Water)

From: The Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara, Chittur Taluk, Palakkad District — represented by [Name, designation] and delegation.

Through: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur Constituency.

Date: 15 July 2026, Thiruvananthapuram.

Subject: Request to permit and expedite agricultural electricity connections up to **5 HP** (and, where justified, above 5 HP) for deep irrigation borewells in the rain-shadow panchayats of Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara and adjoining areas of the Chittur block.

1. Respected Sir,

We are farmer-representatives of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara. We respectfully place before you the acute irrigation-power difficulty faced by the farmers of the eastern, rain-shadow part of the Chittur Assembly constituency, and pray for your intervention.

2. The factual position

- 1. Kerala's driest belt.** Chittur — and in particular Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy and Kozhinjampara — lies in the Palakkad Gap **rain-shadow region**, the driest tract in Kerala. Annual rainfall here is only about **1,000 mm (and often less)**, against the State average of roughly **3,000 mm** — barely **one-third** of the State average. The surrounding hills block the rain-bearing winds.
- 2. A "Critical" groundwater block.** As per the Central Ground Water Board's *National Compilation on Dynamic Ground Water Resources of India (2023 and 2024)*, **Chittur is one of only two or three "Critical" groundwater blocks in the entire State of Kerala** (along with Malampuzha and Kasaragod), where the stage of groundwater extraction is between 90% and 100%.
- 3. Deepening borewells.** Because surface water is scarce and rainfall is low, farmers depend almost entirely on borewells. Water tables have fallen steeply — borewells that were once 400-600 ft now increasingly **cross 800-1,000 ft** in these panchayats.
- 4. The power bottleneck.** Following the groundwater regime tightened after the Plachimada (Perumatty panchayat) bottling-plant water controversy and under the **Kerala Ground Water (Control and Regulation) Act, 2002 and Rules, 2004**, an electricity connection to a well/borewell requires a permit from the Ground Water Authority. In practice, agricultural connections in this belt are effectively held at around **3 HP**; the district-level committee sanctions motors only in the **3-5 HP** band, and anything above 5 HP has to go all the way to the **State-level authority**, causing long delays.
- 5. Why 3 HP is not enough.** A 3 HP pump simply cannot lift adequate water from a borewell that is 800-1,000 ft deep. The result is that farms cannot be irrigated even where a valid well exists, causing crop loss and distress among paddy, banana, coconut and vegetable growers who have no alternative source of water.

3. Our prayer

We humbly request the Hon'ble Minister to:

1. **Sanction agricultural EB connections up to 5 HP as the norm** for genuine cultivators in Eruthempathy, Vadakarapathy, Kozhinjampara (and comparable critical-zone areas of Chittur block) where the certified borewell depth exceeds a reasonable threshold (e.g. 500/800 ft), on production of the Ground Water Authority permit.
2. **Expedite and simplify** clearances for connections **above 5 HP** in genuinely deep borewells, on the basis of a well-depth certificate, without routine referral delays.
3. Establish a **single-window** so that the Ground Water Authority permit and the KSEB connection are processed together within a fixed time limit.
4. **Retain the concessional LT-VA agricultural tariff** for these enhanced-HP irrigation connections.
5. Consider **dedicated agricultural feeders and solar-pump support (PM-KUSUM / State schemes)** so that the higher connected load does not raise the farmer's cost, and to make deep-borewell irrigation energy-efficient (paired with drip/micro-irrigation).

We are willing to furnish panchayat-wise lists of affected farmers, borewell-depth data and pending connection applications.

4. Annexures (to be attached)

- Annexure A: Panchayat-wise list of affected farmers and pending/limited connections.
- Annexure B: Borewell depth certificates / sample.
- Annexure C: CGWB categorisation extract for Chittur block.

Respectfully submitted,

For and on behalf of the Chittur Agriculture Marketing Society, Kozhinjampara

[Name, Designation] [Phone / Email]

Endorsed by: Adv. Sumesh Achuthan, MLA, Chittur